

LOCAL NEWS AUGUST 17, 2012

Branch libraries always changing for the better



LIBRARY COLUMN

George Williams



George Williams Associated Press

One of the things I get to do from time to time in my job as Access Services Manager for the Latah County Library District is to fill in for our couriers when one of our regular people can't work. Due to some changes and vacations over the summer, I've gotten to fill in at this job several times in the past three months.

At least twice a week LCLD transports materials between all seven of our branch libraries. Our Moscow branch acts as the center of our distribution hub, and new and requested library materials get moved from branch to branch on Tuesdays and Thursdays (or sometimes on Fridays) of each week.

I wrote about this process in 2008 and I was thinking of that article as I was filling in for our courier last week. As I thought back to 2008 I realized that a lot of changes have taken place since then - many of which have just happened recently.

At the Genesee branch we now have a handicapped-accessible entrance. This work was done earlier this year by the city of Genesee, which owns the library building. As someone whose mother was in a wheelchair for much of the last 17 years of her life, I really appreciate this change. It also makes delivering library materials easier.

In Troy, the Troy Friends of the Library have been busy rearranging the layout of the library. In February the Friends bought two "gondola" style shelves and then received several more shelves from BookPeople of Moscow after their renovation was complete.

The Juliaetta branch recently got four new public computers. In the last year or so they've also gotten some new shelves and rearranged a lot of books too. One other thing I noticed is that the wooden historical marker at the Juliaetta branch indicating that the library used to be the Rebekah Assembly Hall has been replaced with a new metal sign.

In Bovill I noticed that the interior of the library has been rearranged - again. Treva, our new branch supervisor in Bovill, loves to rearrange things, and in the last year I don't think I've been to the Bovill branch twice and not noticed some bookcase moved or a collection of books moved to a different shelf. Changes have been small but the overall effect is that the library looks a lot different than it did in 2008.

Changes at the Potlatch branch are mostly outdoors, where the garden area has been renamed the Tyler Brady Memorial Garden. In addition to new plantings, the Friends of the Potlatch Library have also added a bench, an arbor and a playhouse in memory of Potlatch native Tyler Brady.

The library that has undergone the most dramatic change since 2008 is our Deary branch. In addition to the interior remodeling in 2010, which included new shelves, new paint and a new ceiling fan, the Deary branch is now getting a new awning and sidewalk courtesy of local volunteers. You probably read Maxine's column a couple of weeks ago about this major project.

The changes are numerous, and I've only been able to scratch the surface of the many things that have happened since 2008, but there is one thing that hasn't changed. The Latah County Library District couldn't survive without the support of the cities of Bovill, Deary, Genesee, Juliaetta, Moscow, Potlatch or Troy. We also couldn't survive without the support of our local volunteers or the Friends of

the Library organizations in each of these communities. The one thing I hope never changes is the support we receive from our local communities and volunteers.

George Williams is the access services manager for the Latah County Library District.

